

Word family: **exact / exactly / exactness / inexact / inexactly**

Base word: exact

Related forms: exactly, exactness, inexact, inexactly

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞) / noun-related form (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “That is **exactly** why I think he is such an interesting person.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **exactly** means **precisely; for that very reason and no other**.

The speaker is emphasizing that the qualities just described are the precise reason he finds Mr. Wong interesting.

繁體中文：***完全正是；準確地指向前面所說的原因或內容，沒有偏差**

中文翻譯：

> “That is **exactly** why I think he is such an interesting person.”

「那**正正就是 / 完全就是**我覺得他非常有趣的原因。」

Here:

exactly why = 正正就是.....的原因

1. **exactly = precisely / with complete accuracy (準確地) — 準確地；精確地**

This is the basic adverb meaning.

Meaning: In a completely accurate or precise way, without approximation or error.

Practice 1

> “Tell me **exactly** what happened.”

「準確地告訴我**究竟發生了甚麼**。」

Practice 2

> “The two measurements are **exactly** the same.”

「兩個測量結果**完全一樣 / 精確相同**。」

****exactly** = 在數量、內容、位置或描述上完全準確，沒有誤差或模糊******

Common:

- * exactly right
- * exactly the same
- * exactly ten minutes
- * exactly what I mean
- * exactly where

These belong to one precision sense.

2. ****exactly** = precisely that / the very thing (強調一致) — 正是；正正是；就是******

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** Used to emphasize that something is precisely the person, reason, thing, place, idea, etc. being referred to.

Practice 3 — Original

> “That is ****exactly**** why I think he is such an interesting person.”

「那****正正是****我覺得他如此有趣的原因。」

Practice 4

> “That is ****exactly**** what I wanted to say.”

「那****正是****我想說的話。」

Practice 5

> “This is ****exactly**** the kind of place I was looking for.”

「這****正正是****我一直在找的那種地方。」

****exactly** = 強調某個人、事物、原因或說法與所指內容完全一致；正是 / 就是******

This is closely related to precision, but pragmatically it functions as ****strong identification/emphasis**** rather than literal measurement accuracy, so it is useful to separate.

3. **exactly = agreement/confirmation (回應) — 正是 ; 沒錯**

In conversation, **exactly** can stand alone as a response showing strong agreement.

Practice 6

> “So the real problem is poor communication.”

> “**Exactly.**”

「所以真正的問題是溝通不足。」

「**沒錯 / 正是。**」

Practice 7

> “You mean he wasn’t being rude—just tired?”

> “**Exactly.**”

「你的意思是他不是無禮，只是累了？」

「**正是這樣。**」

exactly = 用來表示完全同意對方剛才的說法或理解；沒錯 / 正是如此

This is genuinely useful as a conversational function.

4. **not exactly = not really / not quite (委婉否定) — 不完全是 ; 不算是**

This is a very common pragmatic use.

Practice 8

> “Was the trip relaxing?”

> “Not **exactly**.”

「這次旅程很放鬆嗎？」

「**也不完全是 / 不算是。**」

Practice 9

> “He’s not **exactly** easy to work with.”

「他**可不算是**容易共事的人。」

****not exactly** = 委婉表示某個說法不完全正確，甚至可能相當不符合實際情況******

This deserves explicit treatment because its natural meaning is not simply “not precisely.”

5. ****exactly** = used to challenge or seek clarification (疑問語氣) — 到底；究竟******

In questions, ****exactly** can sharpen the request for precise information.

Practice 10

> “What ****exactly** do you mean?”

「你****究竟 / 到底**是甚麼意思？」

Practice 11

> “Where ****exactly** did you see him?”

「你****究竟 / 準確來說**在哪裡看到他？」

****exactly in questions** = 要求對方提供更準確、更具體或更清楚的資訊******

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1, because the underlying idea is still ****precision**, but it is useful enough to show as a common pattern.

Related form: ****exact**

****Exact** means completely correct, precise, or matching in every relevant detail.

Practice 12

> “What is the ****exact** time?”

「準確時間是甚麼？」

Practice 13

> “This is an ****exact** copy of the original.”

「這是原件的****完全相同 / 精確複製品**。」

****exact = 在數量、內容、形狀或細節上完全準確、沒有偏差的****

Related form: ****exactness****

****Exactness**** means the quality of being precise or accurate.

Practice 14

> “Scientific work requires ****exactness****.”

「科學工作需要高度****精確性****。」

Practice 15

> “He described the scene with remarkable ****exactness****.”

「他以非常高的****準確程度****描述了那個場面。」

****exactness = 精確、準確而沒有偏差的性質或程度****

Related form: ****inexact****

****Inexact**** means not fully precise or accurate.

Practice 16

> “The estimate is necessarily ****inexact****.”

「這個估算必然不是完全****精確的****。」

Practice 17

> “The wording is slightly ****inexact****.”

「這個措辭有少許****不夠準確****。」

****inexact = 並非完全準確、精確或完全吻合的****

Important distinction: ****exactly vs precisely****

These often overlap very strongly.

****exactly****

very common in both everyday and formal English.

****precisely****

often sounds slightly more formal or emphatic.

> “That is exactly what I mean.”

> “That is precisely what I mean.”

Both mean:

「那正是我的意思。」

In measurement contexts, both can mean ****精確地****.

Important distinction: ****exactly vs completely****

****exactly****

focuses on precision or exact correspondence.

****completely****

focuses on total degree or completeness.

> “The two answers are exactly the same.”

= 兩個答案完全相同，重點是精確一致。

> “The room is completely empty.”

= 房間完全是空的，重點是程度完整。

They can overlap, but the semantic focus differs.

Important distinction: ****exactly vs actually****

These are often confused by learners.

****exactly****

= precisely / exactly so

****actually****

= in fact / in reality

> “That’s exactly what happened.”

= 那正正就是發生的事情。

> “That’s actually what happened.”

= 事實上就是那樣發生的。

The first emphasizes ****precision/matching****; the second emphasizes ****reality/correction****.

Important distinction: ****exactly vs really****

****exactly****

= precisely

****really****

can mean genuinely, very, or in fact.

> “What exactly happened?”

= 究竟發生了甚麼？要求具體準確內容。

> “What really happened?”

= 真正發生了甚麼？強調事實真相。

Different focus.

Important distinction: ****exact vs accurate****

exact

means fully precise or identical.

accurate

means correct and free from significant error.

A measurement can be:

> accurate but not exact

if it is very close to the true value but not perfectly identical.

So:

****exact = 精確到完全吻合****

****accurate = 正確、準確****

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **exact**

* **exactly**

* **exactness**

* **inexact**

* **inexactly**

Useful constructions include:

* exactly the same

* exactly what/where/why

* exactly right

* not exactly

* Exactly! as a response

The Golden Manual says grammatical constructions and discourse uses should be included when they create genuinely useful learner distinctions, while overlapping precision uses should still be merged rather than over-split.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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exactly — precise accuracy	在數量、內容、位置或描述上完全準確，沒有誤差或模糊
exactly — precisely that / emphasis	強調某個人、事物、原因或說法與所指內容完全一致；正是 / 就是
Exactly! — agreement	表示完全同意對方剛才的說法或理解；沒錯 / 正是如此
not exactly	委婉表示某個說法不完全正確、不算如此，甚至相當不符合實際
exactly in questions	要求提供更準確、具體或清楚的資訊；屬於 precision 義
exact	在數量、內容、形狀或細節上完全準確、沒有偏差的
exactness	精確、準確而沒有偏差的性質或程度
inexact	並非完全準確、精確或吻合的

For your original sentence

> “That is ****exactly**** why I think he is such an interesting person.”

The exact meaning is:

****exactly = 正正是；完全就是****

More specifically:

****exactly why = 正正就是前面所說的那個原因****

So:

> ****That is exactly why...****

= ****那正正就是為甚麼..... / 那完全就是.....的原因****

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for ****exactly****:

1. ****precisely / with complete accuracy****
2. ****precisely that — emphatic identification, “正是 / 就是”****
3. ****standalone agreement — “Exactly!” = 沒錯 / 正是****
4. ****not exactly — pragmatic soft negation, “不完全是 / 不算是”****

I would merge ****what exactly / where exactly / exactly ten**** under #1 rather than artificially split them.